

Notes on Navigation

Trail navigation begins long before the trailhead. Reading the contour lines at the kitchen table builds the mental model that a phone screen cannot replace once fog settles into the valley.

A bearing taken carefully is a promise to your future self. Walk the line in short legs, picking

intermediate landmarks, and the forest stops feeling like a maze.

Rivers are honest obstacles. They tell you exactly how fast they run and how cold they are; the only dishonest element is the hiker's optimism about both.

Turning back is a navigation skill too. The summit is a bonus objective, while the car park is the mandatory one, and the good navigator never confuses the two.